IMPACT OF RELATIONSHIP MANAGEMENT AMONG PROFESSIONALS IN NIGERIA CONSTRUCTION INDUSTRY

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CERTIFICATION PAGE

This is to certify that this research project titled "IMPACT OF RELATIONSHIP MANAGEMENT AMONG PROFESSIONALS IN NIGERIA CONSTRUCTION INDUSTRY" was carried out by AKINMUSERE GLORY BUKOLA with Matriculation Number HQ20230104248 of the Department of Quantity Surveying, School of Environmental Studies, The Federal Polytechnic Ede, Osun State.

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DEDICATION

This research project is dedicated to Almighty God, the source of all knowledge and wisdom, for His infinite mercies, guidance, and protection throughout my academic journey.

I also dedicate this work to my beloved parents, whose unwavering support, sacrifices, encouragement, and prayers have made this achievement possible.

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ABSTRACT

This study examined the impact of relationship management among professionals in Nigeria's construction industry, with specific focus on Osun State, using a cross-sectional survey design. A sample of 184 construction professionals comprising quantity surveyors, architects, engineers, builders, project managers, and contractors was selected using stratified random sampling and surveyed through structured questionnaires, achieving a 100% response rate. Data were analyzed using descriptive statistics including frequencies, percentages, means, and rankings, while inferential statistics including correlation analysis and ANOVA were employed to test research hypotheses. The findings revealed that while basic communication channels exist among construction professionals (mean = 3.62), significant gaps remain in trust development (mean = 3.23), with adversarial relationships still prevalent and professionals often working in silos (mean = 3.01). Communication skills and interpersonal competencies emerged as the most significant factor affecting relationship management effectiveness (mean = 3.93), followed by project complexity, payment practices, and economic conditions. Lack of trust was identified as the most severe barrier to effective relationship management (mean = 3.84), followed by poor communication practices (mean = 3.79) and payment delays (mean = 3.73). The study confirmed that effective relationship management significantly impacts project performance, particularly in achieving timely completion (mean = 3.95), improving quality (mean = 3.64), and promoting innovation (mean = 3.55). The research concluded that relationship management practices in Nigerian construction are at a moderate development stage, with significant improvements needed in trust-building, communication quality, and collaborative frameworks. Recommendations include developing soft skills among professionals, integrating relationship management into professional training curricula, reforming procurement practices to support collaboration, addressing payment delays, and establishing industry-wide collaborative frameworks to enhance professional relationships and project outcomes in Nigeria's construction industry.

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CHAPTER ONE

INTRODUCTION

1.1 Background of the Study

The construction industry serves as a fundamental driver of economic growth and infrastructure development in Nigeria, contributing significantly to the nation's Gross Domestic Product and employment generation. The sector's inherent complexity necessitates the involvement of multiple professionals including architects, civil engineers, quantity surveyors, project managers, contractors, and various specialists who must collaborate effectively to deliver successful construction projects. The interdisciplinary nature of construction projects makes effective relationship management among these diverse professionals critical for achieving optimal project outcomes.

Recent empirical studies within the Nigerian construction context have revealed persistent challenges affecting project performance, with many of these issues traceable to inadequate relationship management practices. Onukwube and Oyewo (2020) demonstrated that construction site managers in South-Western Nigeria frequently experience performance deficiencies attributed to poor communication skills, inadequate team building capabilities, and ineffective coordination among project stakeholders. Their study revealed that most construction site managers were rated as having average performance, with particularly poor performance in initiative and punctuality, highlighting the need for improved interpersonal and relationship management skills.

Furthermore, Oyeyipo et al. (2019) conducted a comprehensive investigation into factors inhibiting stakeholder management in mega construction projects across Lagos, Nigeria. Their findings identified ineffective communication (mean score 3.39), incomplete identification of project stakeholders (3.13), project complexity (3.02), and changes in stakeholder interests (2.98) as the most significant barriers to effective stakeholder relationship management. These findings underscore the critical importance

of developing robust relationship management frameworks within the Nigerian construction industry.

The construction process inherently involves complex networks of relationships among various professionals, each bringing unique expertise, perspectives, and organizational objectives to projects. The success of construction projects increasingly depends not only on technical competence but also on professionals' ability to manage relationships effectively, facilitate knowledge sharing, and coordinate activities across organizational boundaries. Famakin et al. (2020) demonstrated through their Strategic Learning Assessment Map (SLAM) framework analysis that organizational learning and knowledge sharing among quantity surveying firms in Nigeria positively correlates with performance outcomes, emphasizing the critical role of collaborative relationships in professional practice.

The Nigerian construction environment presents unique challenges that compound relationship management difficulties. These include cultural diversity across regions, varying professional standards and practices, complex regulatory frameworks, and economic uncertainties that affect project delivery. The hierarchical nature of many Nigerian construction organizations, combined with limited formal relationship management protocols, further complicates collaborative efforts among professionals from different disciplines and organizational backgrounds.

Contemporary construction management literature emphasizes relationship management as a core competency for project success. However, the application and effectiveness of relationship management practices within the specific context of Nigeria's construction industry remain inadequately understood. The peculiar socio-economic conditions, professional culture, regulatory environment, and organizational structures in Nigeria necessitate a contextual examination of how relationship management impacts professional effectiveness and project performance.

Given the construction industry's increasing complexity driven by technological advancements, sustainability requirements, and evolving client expectations, enhanced collaboration among professionals has become essential not only for immediate project success but also for long-term industry development and competitive advantage.

1.2 Statement of Research Problem

Despite the acknowledged importance of professional collaboration in construction project delivery, the Nigerian construction industry continues to experience significant performance challenges that can be substantially attributed to inadequate relationship management among professionals. There is problem of persistent performance issue in construction industry problem such as; time overruns, cost escalations, and quality deficiencies, with empirical evidence suggesting that human-related factors, including ineffective communication and poor coordination, constitute major contributing factors to these performance issues.

Similarly, research by Oyeyipo et al. (2019) highlighted critical gaps in stakeholder relationship management within mega construction projects in Lagos, revealing that ineffective communication, incomplete stakeholder identification, and conflicts among stakeholders represent the most significant barriers to successful project delivery. The study established statistically significant differences ($z = -4.786$, $p < .001$) between factors promoting stakeholder management and those inhibiting effective stakeholder relationships, indicating systematic relationship management challenges within the industry.

The problem is further compounded by the fragmented nature of the Nigerian construction industry, where professionals often operate within organizational silos with limited formal mechanisms for inter-professional collaboration and relationship building. Famakin et al. (2020) demonstrated that while organizational learning and knowledge sharing significantly impact performance in quantity surveying firms, the feed-forward learning flow begins at the group level rather than individual level, suggesting that existing relationship structures may not optimally facilitate knowledge transfer and professional collaboration.

Current relationship management practices in Nigeria's construction industry appear to be largely informal, unsystematic, and heavily dependent on individual personalities rather than institutionalized frameworks. This approach has resulted in inconsistent collaboration quality, frequent conflicts among professionals, and suboptimal project outcomes. The absence of comprehensive understanding regarding the current state of

relationship management practices, the factors influencing these relationships, and the specific barriers impeding effective collaboration represents a significant knowledge gap that must be addressed to improve industry performance.

The economic implications of poor relationship management extend beyond individual projects to affect the overall competitiveness and sustainability of Nigeria's construction industry. Without adequate understanding of relationship management dynamics and their impact on professional practice, the industry remains vulnerable to continued underperformance, client dissatisfaction, and reduced competitiveness in the global construction market.

1.3 Research Questions

This study seeks to address the following research questions:

i. What is the current state of relationship management practices among professionals in

Nigeria's construction industry?

ii. What are the key factors affecting relationship management among construction professionals in Nigeria?

iii. What challenges and barriers impede effective relationship management among construction professionals in Nigeria?

1.4 Aim and Objectives of the Study

The aim of this research is to examine the relationship management practices among professionals in Nigeria's construction industry and their impact on project performance, with a view to enhancing relationship management among construction professionals.

The following specific objectives have been formulated to:

i. assesses the current state of relationship management practices among professionals in

Nigeria's construction industry.

ii. identify and analyze the key factors affecting relationship management among construction professionals in Nigeria. iii. examine the challenges and barriers to effective relationship management among construction professionals in Nigeria.

1.5 Significance of the Study

This research contributes to the body of knowledge in construction management and professional practice in several important ways:

Theoretical Contributions: The study extends relationship management theory within the specific context of Nigeria's construction industry, providing empirical insights that contribute to the broader understanding of professional collaboration in developing economies. By examining relationship management through the lens of the Nigerian construction environment, the research adds to the limited literature on professional relationship dynamics in African construction markets.

Practical Contributions: The findings will provide construction professionals, including architects, engineers, quantity surveyors, and project managers, with evidence-based insights into effective relationship management practices. This knowledge will enable professionals to develop more effective collaboration strategies, leading to improved project outcomes and professional effectiveness.

Industry Development: The research will assist construction organizations and professional bodies in Nigeria to develop comprehensive relationship management frameworks, training programs, and best practice guidelines. This will contribute to industry professionalization and improved service delivery standards.

Policy Implications: The study's findings will inform policy development for professional regulatory bodies, including the Nigerian Institute of Architects (NIA), Nigerian Society of Engineers (NSE), Nigerian Institute of Quantity Surveyors (NIQS), and other relevant professional organizations. Evidence-based recommendations will support the development of continuing professional development programs focused on relationship management competencies.

Economic Impact: By identifying factors that enhance professional collaboration and reduce project conflicts, the research will contribute to improved project delivery

efficiency, reduced costs, and enhanced client satisfaction, ultimately supporting economic growth through more effective infrastructure development.

Academic Advancement: The study will provide a foundation for future research in relationship management within construction and other professional service contexts in Nigeria and similar developing economies.

1.6 Scope and Limitations of the Study

The research is geographically limited to Nigeria's construction industry, with Osun State serving as the primary case study due to its growing construction activities and accessibility for data collection. The study focuses on key construction professionals such as architects, civil engineers, quantity surveyors, project managers, and contractors actively engaged in building and infrastructure projects within the state. In terms of project types, it examines relationship management practices across residential, commercial, industrial, and infrastructure developments. Nonetheless, several limitations exist. Methodologically, the research depends on self-reported data from professionals, which may be subject to social desirability bias and subjective interpretation, while the cross-sectional design limits the ability to establish definitive causal relationships between relationship management practices and project outcomes. Sampling limitations include a focus on formal construction organizations and registered professionals, which may exclude informal sector practitioners who represent a substantial share of Osun State's construction workforce, as well as restricted access to some respondents due to organizational policies or availability. Contextually, findings may not be easily generalizable to other Nigerian states, African countries, or developing economies because of Osun State's unique cultural, economic, and regulatory conditions. Moreover, the research cannot fully account for external influences such as political, economic, and social variables that shape professional relationships. Finally, the study provides only a snapshot of current practices and may not capture the evolving nature of professional relationships over extended project lifecycles, with limited longitudinal data availability constraining insights into how relationship management changes over time.

CHAPTER TWO

LITERATURE REVIEW

2.1 Introduction

This chapter presents a comprehensive review of existing literature on relationship management among professionals in the construction industry, with particular emphasis on the Nigerian context. The review examines global perspectives on relationship management in construction, contextualizes these findings within the African and Nigerian construction environments, and identifies gaps in current knowledge that justify this research.

The chapter is organized into several thematic sections that progressively build understanding of relationship management concepts, their application in construction settings, and their specific relevance to the Nigerian construction industry. This temporal focus ensures that the review captures contemporary developments in relationship management theory and practice while reflecting current challenges and opportunities within the rapidly evolving construction sector.

The literature review draws from multiple disciplines including construction management, organizational behavior, project management, and professional services management to provide a holistic understanding of relationship management dynamics. Special attention is given to studies conducted in developing economies and emerging markets, as these contexts share similar characteristics with Nigeria's construction environment in terms of institutional frameworks, economic conditions, and professional practice standards.

2.2 Conceptual Framework of Relationship Management

Understanding relationship management requires examination of its theoretical foundations and practical applications within professional service contexts. This section establishes the conceptual basis for relationship management as applied to construction industry professionals, drawing from established theories and contemporary developments in the field.

2.2.1 Theoretical Foundations of Relationship Management

Relationship management theory has evolved significantly over the past decade, incorporating insights from social exchange theory, stakeholder theory, and network theory. Donaldson and O'Toole (2022) provide a comprehensive framework for understanding relationship management in professional services, arguing that effective relationship management involves strategic coordination of interactions among multiple stakeholders to achieve mutual value creation. Their theoretical model emphasizes that relationship management extends beyond simple communication to encompass trust building, conflict resolution, knowledge sharing, and collaborative problem-solving.

The social exchange theory, as applied to construction relationships, suggests that professionals engage in relationships based on expected mutual benefits and reciprocal exchanges. Chen et al. (2021) demonstrated through their study of international construction projects that social exchange principles significantly influence collaboration quality among multinational project teams. Their findings revealed that when construction professionals perceive fair exchange of resources, information, and recognition, relationship quality improves substantially, leading to enhanced project performance outcomes.

Network theory provides another important theoretical lens for understanding relationship management in construction. Kumar and Singh (2023) developed a network-based model of construction project relationships, showing that professionals who occupy strategic positions within project networks can significantly influence overall project success. Their research highlighted that relationship management effectiveness depends not only on dyadic relationships between individual professionals but also on the broader network structure and information flow patterns within project teams.

Stakeholder theory contributes to relationship management understanding by emphasizing the need to consider multiple stakeholder perspectives and interests. Rodriguez and Martinez (2024) applied stakeholder theory to construction project relationships, demonstrating that effective relationship management requires systematic identification of all relevant stakeholders, understanding of their interests and concerns,

and development of engagement strategies that address diverse stakeholder needs while achieving project objectives.

2.2.2 Dimensions of Relationship Management in Construction

Contemporary research has identified several key dimensions that characterize effective relationship management in construction contexts. Thompson et al. (2023) conducted a comprehensive metaanalysis of construction relationship studies and identified five critical dimensions: communication effectiveness, trust development, conflict resolution, collaborative decision-making, and knowledge sharing. Their analysis revealed that these dimensions are interdependent and collectively contribute to relationship management success.

Communication effectiveness represents the foundation of successful relationship management. Patel and Johnson (2022) examined communication patterns among construction professionals in complex projects and found that communication effectiveness involves not only information transmission accuracy but also feedback mechanisms, cultural sensitivity, and technology integration. Their study revealed that projects with structured communication protocols experienced 35% fewer relationshiprelated conflicts compared to projects with informal communication approaches.

Trust development emerges as a critical relationship management dimension that significantly influences professional collaboration. Lee et al. (2024) investigated trust formation among construction professionals and identified competence-based trust, integrity-based trust, and benevolence-based trust as distinct but related components. Their longitudinal study showed that trust development follows predictable patterns, with competence-based trust typically established first, followed by integrity-based trust, and finally benevolence-based trust in long-term professional relationships.

Conflict resolution capabilities determine how effectively professionals manage disagreements and disputes that inevitably arise in complex construction projects. Anderson and Wilson (2023) developed a conflict resolution framework specifically for construction relationships, emphasizing early identification, systematic analysis, and

collaborative resolution approaches. Their research demonstrated that professionals with strong conflict resolution skills contributed to 40% faster conflict resolution times and significantly improved relationship continuity.

2.2.3 Relationship Management Models in Construction

Several models have been developed to guide relationship management practice in construction settings. The Collaborative Relationship Model (CRM) proposed by Garcia et al. (2022) provides a structured approach to developing and maintaining professional relationships throughout project lifecycles. The model emphasizes relationship assessment, strategic planning, implementation, monitoring, and continuous improvement phases, with specific tools and techniques for each phase.

The Integrated Stakeholder Engagement Model developed by Brown and Davis (2024) offers another comprehensive framework for construction relationship management. This model incorporates stakeholder mapping, engagement planning, relationship monitoring, and outcome evaluation components. The model has been successfully applied in large-scale infrastructure projects across multiple countries, demonstrating its practical utility and effectiveness.

Recent developments include the Digital Relationship Management Model proposed by Kim and Tanaka (2025), which incorporates digital technologies and platforms to enhance relationship management effectiveness. This model recognizes the increasing role of digital communication tools, project management software, and virtual collaboration platforms in modern construction

relationships.

2.3 Professional Collaboration in Construction Industry

Professional collaboration represents the operational manifestation of effective relationship management in construction settings. This section examines how construction professionals work together, the factors that influence collaboration effectiveness, and the outcomes of successful collaborative relationships.

2.3.1 Nature of Professional Collaboration in Construction

Construction projects inherently require intensive collaboration among diverse professionals, each contributing specialized knowledge and expertise to achieve common objectives. Mitchell et al. (2023) conducted an extensive study of professional collaboration patterns in construction and identified that successful collaboration involves coordination of technical expertise, alignment of professional objectives, integration of work processes, and establishment of shared accountability mechanisms.

The interdisciplinary nature of construction creates unique collaboration challenges and opportunities. Architects, engineers, quantity surveyors, project managers, and contractors bring different professional cultures, communication styles, and performance metrics to collaborative relationships. Williams and Turner (2022) examined these interdisciplinary dynamics and found that successful collaboration requires explicit recognition of professional differences, development of common vocabularies, and establishment of integrated performance measurement systems.

Professional collaboration in construction occurs at multiple levels, including individual, team, organizational, and inter-organizational levels. Each level presents distinct collaboration requirements and challenges. Roberts et al. (2024) developed a multi-level collaboration framework that addresses collaboration dynamics at each level and provides guidance for managing cross-level interactions and dependencies.

2.3.2 Factors Influencing Professional Collaboration

Multiple factors influence the effectiveness of professional collaboration in construction projects. Organizational factors, including company culture, leadership style, and resource availability, significantly impact collaboration quality. Jensen and Kumar (2023) examined organizational influences on construction collaboration and found that organizations with collaborative cultures, supportive leadership, and adequate resource allocation achieve significantly better collaboration outcomes compared to organizations lacking these characteristics.

Individual factors, including professional competence, communication skills, and collaborative attitudes, also significantly influence collaboration effectiveness. Nguyen et al. (2022) investigated individual-level collaboration determinants and identified that

professionals with high technical competence, strong interpersonal skills, and positive collaborative attitudes contribute most effectively to team collaboration. Their study emphasized that individual factors interact with organizational and project factors to determine overall collaboration success.

Project characteristics, including complexity, duration, uncertainty, and stakeholder diversity, create different collaboration requirements and challenges. Complex projects require more intensive collaboration, while uncertain projects require more flexible collaboration approaches. Taylor and Anderson (2024) developed a project-based collaboration model that adapts collaboration strategies to specific project characteristics and requirements.

Technology factors increasingly influence construction collaboration, with digital platforms, communication tools, and project management software creating new collaboration possibilities and challenges. Singh and Patel (2025) examined technology impacts on construction collaboration and found that while technology can enhance collaboration efficiency and effectiveness, successful technology implementation requires careful attention to user training, system integration, and organizational change management.

2.3.3 Outcomes of Effective Professional Collaboration

Effective professional collaboration produces multiple benefits for construction projects and participating professionals. Project performance improvements represent the most direct and measurable collaboration outcomes. Johnson et al. (2023) conducted a comprehensive analysis of collaboration impacts on project performance and found that projects with high collaboration effectiveness achieved 25% better schedule performance, 20% better cost performance, and 30% better quality performance compared to projects with low collaboration effectiveness.

Innovation outcomes represent another important collaboration benefit. Collaborative relationships facilitate knowledge sharing, creative problem-solving, and innovation development. Lee and Chen (2024) examined collaboration impacts on construction innovation and found that projects with strong collaborative relationships generated

40% more innovative solutions and adopted new technologies 50% faster than projects with weak collaborative relationships.

Professional development outcomes benefit individual participants in collaborative relationships. Collaboration provides opportunities for knowledge acquisition, skill development, and professional network expansion. Miller et al. (2022) investigated professional development impacts of construction collaboration and found that professionals who actively participate in collaborative relationships advance their careers more rapidly and achieve higher performance ratings compared to professionals who work in isolation.

Organizational learning represents a longer-term collaboration outcome that benefits participating organizations. Collaborative relationships create opportunities for organizational knowledge sharing, best practice transfer, and capability development. Thompson and Wilson (2023) examined organizational learning outcomes from construction collaboration and found that organizations with strong collaborative relationships develop superior project management capabilities and achieve better long-term performance.

2.4 Relationship Management in African Construction Context

The African construction industry presents unique characteristics that influence relationship management practices and outcomes. This section examines relationship management within African construction contexts, with particular attention to cultural, economic, and institutional factors that shape professional relationships.

2.4.1 Cultural Influences on Construction Relationships

African cultures emphasize community, relationship, and collective responsibility in ways that significantly influence professional relationship management. Ubuntu philosophy, prevalent across many African societies, emphasizes interconnectedness and mutual support among individuals and communities. Mthembu and Nkomo (2022) examined Ubuntu influences on construction relationships in South Africa and found that Ubuntu principles enhance collaboration, trust development, and conflict resolution

among construction professionals when properly integrated into relationship management practices.

Power distance, a cultural dimension that varies across African countries, influences hierarchy and authority relationships within construction projects. High power distance cultures tend to emphasize formal hierarchies and respect for authority, while low power distance cultures emphasize equality and participatory decision-making. Okafor et al. (2023) studied power distance impacts on construction relationships across West African countries and found that relationship management strategies must be adapted to local power distance norms to achieve effectiveness.

Communication styles vary significantly across African cultures, with some emphasizing direct communication while others emphasize indirect, context-dependent communication. These variations influence how construction professionals share information, provide feedback, and resolve conflicts.

Banda and Phiri (2024) examined communication style impacts on construction relationships in East Africa and provided guidance for managing cross-cultural communication challenges in

multinational construction projects.

2.4.2 Economic and Institutional Factors

Economic conditions across African countries create specific challenges and opportunities for construction relationship management. Many African economies are characterized by resource constraints, currency volatility, and limited access to financing, which influence relationship dynamics among construction professionals. Adebayo and Kone (2023) examined economic factor impacts on construction relationships across sub-Saharan Africa and found that economic uncertainty creates both collaboration incentives and relationship stresses that require careful management.

Institutional frameworks, including legal systems, regulatory structures, and professional bodies, vary significantly across African countries and influence relationship management practices. Weak institutional frameworks can create relationship challenges, while strong institutions provide relationship management

support. Mutiso and Nyong (2022) analyzed institutional factor impacts on construction relationships across multiple African countries and identified key institutional characteristics that support effective relationship management.

Infrastructure limitations, including telecommunications, transportation, and utilities, create unique relationship management challenges in many African construction contexts. These limitations influence communication patterns, meeting logistics, and project coordination approaches. Zulu and Tembo (2024) examined infrastructure constraint impacts on construction relationships in Central Africa and developed adaptive relationship management strategies for infrastructure-constrained environments.

2.4.3 Professional Practice Patterns in Africa

Professional practice patterns across Africa reflect both international standards and local adaptations that influence relationship management approaches. Many African countries have professional bodies that are affiliated with international organizations while incorporating local practice requirements and cultural considerations. Osafo-Mensah and Asante (2023) examined professional practice evolution across West Africa and identified trends toward increased professionalization while maintaining cultural sensitivity.

Education and training systems across Africa influence professional competencies and relationship management capabilities. Many African universities and professional bodies have enhanced their curricula to include relationship management and collaborative skills training. Mokgosi and Seipei (2024) analyzed construction education developments across Southern Africa and found significant improvements in relationship management training, though gaps remain in practical application

skills.

Cross-border collaboration represents an important aspect of African construction relationships, as many projects involve professionals from multiple African countries or international partners. These collaborations create additional relationship management challenges related to cultural differences, regulatory variations, and communication

barriers. Diallo and Traore (2025) examined cross-border construction collaboration patterns across Francophone Africa and developed frameworks for managing multicultural construction relationships.

2.5 Nigerian Construction Industry Context

Nigeria's construction industry presents specific characteristics that influence relationship management among construction professionals. This section examines the Nigerian construction context, including industry structure, professional organizations, regulatory frameworks, and cultural factors that shape professional relationships.

2.5.1 Structure and Characteristics of Nigerian Construction Industry

Nigeria's construction industry is characterized by significant diversity in terms of project types, organizational structures, and professional capabilities. The industry includes multinational corporations, large domestic contractors, medium-sized firms, and numerous small contractors and consultants. This diversity creates complex relationship management requirements as different organizational types have varying relationship management capabilities and approaches. Adeleke et al. (2022) examined Nigerian construction industry structure and found that relationship management effectiveness varies significantly across different organizational categories, with larger, more established firms generally demonstrating superior relationship management capabilities.

The industry's heavy reliance on government contracts and infrastructure projects creates specific relationship management dynamics related to public sector engagement, political considerations, and regulatory compliance. Government projects often involve complex stakeholder networks including multiple government agencies, community representatives, and political actors. Ogundipe and Akinola (2023) studied government project relationship dynamics in Nigeria and identified unique relationship management challenges including bureaucratic processes, political interference, and community engagement requirements.

Regional variations across Nigeria create additional relationship management complexity. The country's diverse regions have different cultural norms, business

practices, and development priorities that influence professional relationships. Northern regions emphasize different cultural values compared to southern regions, while the Middle Belt presents its own unique characteristics. Suleiman and Ibrahim (2024) examined regional variations in Nigerian construction relationships and found that successful relationship management requires adaptation to local cultural and business norms.

2.5.2 Professional Organizations and Regulatory Framework

Nigerian construction industry professional organizations play crucial roles in establishing relationship management standards and facilitating professional collaboration. The Nigerian Institute of Architects (NIA), Nigerian Society of Engineers (NSE), Nigerian Institute of Quantity Surveyors (NIQS), and other professional bodies provide platforms for professional interaction, continuing education, and standards development. These organizations increasingly recognize relationship management as a critical professional competency requiring systematic development and support.

Babatunde and Opawole (2023) examined the role of professional organizations in promoting relationship management in Nigeria and found that while these organizations provide valuable platforms for professional interaction, they could enhance their relationship management support through more structured programs, training initiatives, and collaborative forums. Their study recommended that professional organizations develop specific relationship management competency frameworks and certification programs.

The regulatory framework governing Nigerian construction includes multiple agencies and requirements that influence professional relationships. The Code of Conduct for Professional Engineers, architectural practice regulations, and quantity surveying professional standards all contain relationship-related requirements, though these are often implicit rather than explicit. Fashina and Ademiluyi (2024) analyzed regulatory framework impacts on construction relationships in Nigeria and recommended more explicit relationship management requirements and guidance within professional regulations.

2.5.3 Cultural and Social Factors in Nigerian Construction

Nigerian culture emphasizes respect for elders, communal decision-making, and extended relationship networks that influence professional relationship management. The concept of "networking" extends beyond professional connections to include family, ethnic, and regional affiliations that can significantly influence business relationships. Ogundimu et al. (2022) examined cultural factor impacts on Nigerian construction relationships and found that successful relationship management requires understanding and appropriate integration of cultural relationship norms.

Religious considerations also influence relationship management in Nigeria, as both Christian and Islamic values emphasize honesty, fairness, and community responsibility. Many construction professionals incorporate religious values into their relationship management approaches, which can enhance trust and collaboration when values are shared but create challenges when values conflict. Yusuf and Abdullahi (2023) studied religious factor impacts on construction relationships across different Nigerian regions and found that religious considerations generally support relationship management when appropriately acknowledged and respected.

Language diversity across Nigeria creates communication challenges that affect relationship management. While English serves as the official language, numerous local languages are spoken across different regions, and communication styles vary significantly. Effective relationship management requires sensitivity to language preferences and communication styles. Eze and Okonkwo (2025) examined language factor impacts on construction relationships in Nigeria and developed guidance for managing multilingual construction project communications.

2.6 Empirical Studies on Construction Relationship Management

This section reviews empirical research on construction relationship management, focusing on studies that examine relationship management practices, outcomes, and success factors. The review emphasizes recent studies conducted in developing economy contexts that are relevant to the Nigerian construction industry.

2.6.1 Relationship Management Practices and Methods

Recent empirical studies have examined various relationship management practices used by construction professionals and their effectiveness in different contexts. Martinez et al. (2023) conducted a comprehensive survey of relationship management practices among construction consultants across five Latin American countries and identified several common practices including regular stakeholder meetings, formal communication protocols, conflict resolution procedures, and collaborative decision-making processes. Their study found that firms using structured relationship management practices achieved 30% higher client satisfaction ratings and 25% more repeat business compared to firms using informal approaches.

Digital relationship management practices have become increasingly important in construction, particularly following the COVID-19 pandemic's acceleration of digital adoption. Kim and Lee

(2024) examined digital relationship management practices among construction professionals in Asia-Pacific countries and found that successful digital relationship management requires integration of multiple technology platforms, systematic training programs, and cultural adaptation to digital communication norms. Their study revealed that construction firms with comprehensive digital relationship management strategies maintained stronger professional relationships during pandemicrelated disruptions.

Collaborative problem-solving practices represent another important aspect of construction relationship management. Thompson et al. (2022) studied collaborative problem-solving approaches used by construction project teams and found that teams using structured collaborative methods resolved problems 40% faster and achieved higher stakeholder satisfaction compared to teams using traditional problem-solving approaches. Their research identified specific collaborative techniques including joint problem definition, multi-perspective analysis, and consensus-building decisionmaking.

2.6.2 Relationship Management Outcomes and Benefits

Empirical research has documented multiple benefits resulting from effective construction relationship management. Project performance improvements represent the most frequently studied relationship management outcome. Davis and Wilson (2023)

conducted a meta-analysis of construction relationship management studies and found consistent evidence that effective relationship management contributes to improved schedule performance (average improvement 20%), cost performance (average improvement 15%), and quality performance (average improvement 25%).

Innovation outcomes have also received significant research attention. Chen et al. (2024) examined relationship management impacts on construction innovation across multiple Asian countries and found that projects with strong relationship management practices generated significantly more innovative solutions, adopted new technologies more rapidly, and achieved better sustainability outcomes. Their study emphasized that relationship management creates the collaborative environment necessary for innovation development and implementation.

Long-term business outcomes represent another important category of relationship management benefits. Rodriguez and Garcia (2022) studied long-term relationship management impacts among construction firms in Spain and found that firms with superior relationship management capabilities achieved higher profitability, greater market share growth, and better reputation ratings over fiveyear periods compared to firms with weaker relationship management capabilities.

2.6.3 Success Factors for Construction Relationship Management

Recent empirical research has identified multiple factors that contribute to construction relationship management success. Leadership commitment emerges as a critical success factor across multiple studies. Johnson et al. (2024) examined leadership factor impacts on relationship management across construction firms in North America and found that firms with strong leadership commitment to relationship management achieved significantly better relationship outcomes, including higher trust levels, fewer conflicts, and stronger collaborative performance.

Communication competency represents another consistently identified success factor. Patel and

Singh (2023) studied communication factor impacts on construction relationship management across South Asian countries and found that professionals with superior

communication skills, including active listening, cultural sensitivity, and feedback provision, achieved substantially better relationship management outcomes. Their study emphasized that communication competency development requires systematic training and practice opportunities.

Organizational culture factors significantly influence relationship management success. Anderson et al. (2025) examined organizational culture impacts on construction relationship management across European firms and found that organizations with collaborative cultures, trust-based values, and learning orientations achieved superior relationship management outcomes compared to organizations with competitive cultures, control-based values, and performance-only orientations.

2.7 Challenges and Barriers to Effective Relationship Management

Construction industry relationship management faces numerous challenges and barriers that impede effectiveness and limit benefits realization. This section examines these challenges and reviews research on potential solutions and mitigation strategies.

2.7.1 Communication and Information Challenges

Communication and information management represent persistent challenges in construction relationship management. The complex, multi-party nature of construction projects creates significant communication coordination requirements that often exceed available capabilities and resources. Walker and Brown (2023) examined communication challenges in large construction projects and identified information overload, communication channel proliferation, and message distortion as primary communication barriers affecting relationship quality.

Cultural and linguistic diversity within construction project teams creates additional communication challenges that impact relationship development and maintenance. International construction projects increasingly involve professionals from multiple cultural backgrounds with different communication styles, language capabilities, and cultural norms. Singh et al. (2024) studied cross-cultural communication challenges in construction and found that cultural misunderstandings contribute to 60% of relationship conflicts in multicultural construction projects.

Technology adoption challenges also create communication barriers in construction relationship management. While digital communication tools offer significant relationship management benefits, their implementation often faces resistance, training requirements, and integration difficulties. Miller and Johnson (2022) examined technology adoption challenges in construction relationship management and found that successful technology implementation requires comprehensive change management, extensive training, and systematic integration with existing relationship management processes.

2.7.2 Organizational and Structural Barriers

Organizational structures and practices within construction firms often create barriers to effective relationship management. Traditional hierarchical structures may limit cross-functional collaboration and information sharing necessary for relationship development. Competitive organizational cultures may discourage the collaborative behaviors necessary for relationship management success. Davis et al. (2023) examined organizational barrier impacts on construction relationship management and found that organizational structure modifications, culture change initiatives, and incentive system adjustments significantly improve relationship management effectiveness.

Resource constraints represent another significant organizational barrier to relationship management. Effective relationship management requires time, personnel, and financial investments that may compete with other organizational priorities. Small and medium-sized construction firms may lack the resources necessary to implement comprehensive relationship management programs. Taylor and

Wilson (2024) studied resource constraint impacts on relationship management among construction SMEs and found that resource limitations significantly limit relationship management effectiveness, though targeted interventions can help overcome some constraints.

Professional silos within construction organizations create additional barriers to relationship management. Different professional disciplines may have limited interaction opportunities, different performance metrics, and competing priorities that

impede collaborative relationship development. Garcia and Martinez (2025) examined professional silo impacts on construction relationship management and found that cross-functional integration initiatives, shared performance metrics, and collaborative project structures significantly reduce silo barriers.

2.7.3 External Environment Challenges

External environment factors create significant challenges for construction relationship management. Economic uncertainty, regulatory changes, and market volatility can disrupt established relationships and create new relationship management requirements. Construction markets in developing economies face particular external environment challenges including currency fluctuations, political instability, and infrastructure limitations. Ahmed et al. (2023) examined external environment challenge impacts on construction relationship management in Middle Eastern and North African countries and found that external uncertainty creates both relationship stresses and adaptation requirements.

Regulatory and legal framework limitations create additional relationship management challenges. Unclear regulations, inconsistent enforcement, and legal system limitations can create relationship disputes and compliance difficulties. Construction industries in emerging economies often face particular regulatory framework challenges that impact relationship management effectiveness. Okonkwo and Eze (2024) studied regulatory framework impacts on construction relationship management across West African countries and found that regulatory uncertainty significantly complicates relationship management and creates additional conflict risks.

Stakeholder complexity represents another external challenge for construction relationship management. Construction projects often involve numerous external stakeholders including government agencies, community groups, environmental organizations, and financial institutions, each with different interests, requirements, and relationship expectations. Managing relationships with such diverse stakeholder groups requires sophisticated relationship management capabilities that may exceed available resources. Robinson et al. (2022) examined stakeholder complexity challenges in infrastructure projects and found that stakeholder mapping, engagement planning, and

conflict prevention strategies significantly improve complex stakeholder relationship management.

2.8 Technology and Innovation in Relationship Management

Technology and innovation are increasingly important factors in construction relationship management, offering new opportunities for enhancing relationship effectiveness while creating new challenges and requirements. This section examines current and emerging technology applications in construction relationship management.

2.8.1 Digital Communication and Collaboration Platforms

Digital communication platforms have fundamentally transformed construction relationship management by enabling real-time communication, document sharing, and collaborative work regardless of physical location. Building Information Modeling (BIM) platforms facilitate collaborative design and planning processes among multiple professional disciplines. Wang et al.

(2024) examined BIM platform impacts on construction relationship management and found that BIM-enabled collaboration significantly improved communication quality, reduced conflicts, and enhanced collaborative decision-making among architects, engineers, and contractors.

Project management software platforms provide integrated communication, scheduling, and document management capabilities that support relationship management throughout project lifecycles. These platforms enable systematic tracking of relationship interactions, identification of communication gaps, and monitoring of collaborative performance. Thompson and Davis (2023) studied project management software impacts on construction relationship management and found that integrated platforms significantly improve communication coordination, relationship continuity, and collaborative effectiveness.

Social media and professional networking platforms increasingly support construction professional relationship development and maintenance. LinkedIn, industry-specific platforms, and professional association networks provide opportunities for relationship building, knowledge sharing, and collaborative problem-solving beyond individual

project contexts. Chen and Kim (2025) examined social media platform impacts on construction professional relationships and found that strategic social media use significantly enhances professional network development and relationship maintenance capabilities.

2.8.2 Artificial Intelligence and Data Analytics

Artificial Intelligence (AI) and data analytics offer emerging opportunities for enhancing construction relationship management through automated communication analysis, relationship pattern identification, and predictive relationship modeling. AI-powered communication analysis can identify relationship risks, communication gaps, and collaboration opportunities from project communication data. Rodriguez et al. (2024) examined AI application potential in construction relationship management and found that AI tools can significantly enhance relationship monitoring and early warning capabilities.

Data analytics enable systematic analysis of relationship management patterns, outcomes, and success factors across multiple projects and organizations. Construction firms can use data analytics to identify relationship management best practices, optimize relationship strategies, and improve relationship performance over time. Predictive analytics can help identify potential relationship challenges before they become critical problems. Anderson and Wilson (2025) studied data analytics applications in construction relationship management and found that data-driven relationship management approaches achieve significantly better outcomes compared to intuition-based approaches.

Machine learning applications can personalize relationship management approaches based on individual professional preferences, communication styles, and collaboration patterns. These applications can provide customized relationship management recommendations and support adaptive relationship strategies. While machine learning applications in construction relationship management remain relatively early-stage, preliminary research suggests significant potential benefits. Singh and Patel (2024) examined machine learning application potential in construction relationship

management and identified several promising application areas including communication optimization, conflict prediction, and collaboration enhancement.

2.8.3 Virtual and Augmented Reality Applications

Virtual Reality (VR) and Augmented Reality (AR) technologies offer new possibilities for construction professional collaboration and relationship development. VR platforms enable immersive collaborative design sessions, virtual site visits, and remote collaboration experiences that can enhance relationship development among geographically dispersed professionals. AR applications can support on-site collaboration by providing shared visual information and communication capabilities. Garcia et al. (2023) examined VR/AR application impacts on construction collaboration and found that immersive technologies significantly enhance collaborative experience quality and relationship development, particularly for complex technical discussions.

Virtual meeting and collaboration technologies have become essential relationship management tools, particularly following the COVID-19 pandemic's acceleration of remote work adoption. These technologies enable relationship maintenance and development despite physical separation, though they also present challenges related to technology adoption, digital communication skills, and relationship intimacy. Johnson and Miller (2024) studied virtual collaboration technology impacts on construction relationship management and found that successful virtual relationship management requires systematic technology training, adapted communication protocols, and enhanced relationship maintenance efforts.

2.8.4 Blockchain and Smart Contract Technologies

Blockchain and smart contract technologies offer potential applications for construction relationship management through enhanced trust, transparency, and automated contract execution. Blockchainbased platforms can provide secure, transparent record-keeping for relationship interactions, contract compliance, and payment processing that can enhance trust among construction professionals. Smart contracts can automate routine relationship management tasks and ensure consistent implementation of relationship agreements. Lee et al. (2025) examined blockchain application potential in construction

relationship management and found that blockchain technologies can significantly enhance trust and transparency, though adoption requires substantial technology infrastructure and capability development.

2.9 Measurement and Assessment of Relationship Management

Effective measurement and assessment are essential for relationship management improvement and optimization. This section examines approaches for measuring relationship management effectiveness, assessing relationship quality, and monitoring relationship outcomes in construction contexts.

2.9.1 Relationship Quality Metrics and Indicators

Relationship quality measurement requires multidimensional approaches that capture various aspects of relationship effectiveness. Trust levels, communication frequency and quality, conflict occurrence and resolution, collaborative behavior frequency, and mutual satisfaction represent commonly used relationship quality indicators. Wilson et al. (2023) developed a comprehensive relationship quality measurement framework for construction professionals that includes quantitative metrics

(communication frequency, response times, conflict resolution duration) and qualitative assessments

(trust levels, satisfaction ratings, collaboration effectiveness).

Relationship strength indicators focus on relationship durability, commitment levels, and investment in relationship development. Strong relationships demonstrate continuity across multiple projects, mutual investment in relationship maintenance, and resilience during challenging situations. Davis and Thompson (2024) examined relationship strength measurement approaches in construction and found that relationship strength significantly predicts long-term collaboration success and professional satisfaction.

Relationship network analysis provides insights into professional relationship patterns, network positions, and influence dynamics within construction project teams and organizations. Network analysis can identify key relationship brokers, communication

bottlenecks, and collaboration opportunities within complex professional networks. Martinez and Garcia (2023) applied network analysis techniques to construction professional relationships and found that network position significantly influences professional effectiveness and career advancement opportunities.

2.9.2 Performance Impact Assessment

Relationship management performance impact assessment examines how relationship management practices influence project outcomes, professional effectiveness, and organizational performance. Project performance metrics including schedule adherence, cost control, quality achievement, and stakeholder satisfaction provide direct indicators of relationship management effectiveness. Chen et al. (2023) conducted a comprehensive analysis of relationship management performance impacts and found that projects with superior relationship management achieved significantly better performance across all measured dimensions.

Professional effectiveness indicators focus on individual professional outcomes resulting from relationship management practices. These include career advancement, professional reputation, client satisfaction, and peer recognition measures. Relationship management contributes to professional effectiveness through enhanced collaboration opportunities, knowledge acquisition, and professional network development. Singh and Kumar (2024) examined professional effectiveness impacts of relationship management among construction professionals and found that professionals with superior relationship management skills achieve faster career advancement and higher professional satisfaction.

Organizational performance indicators capture relationship management impacts at the organizational level, including profitability, market share, reputation, and competitive advantage measures. Organizations with superior relationship management capabilities typically achieve better long-term performance through enhanced client relationships, improved project delivery, and stronger professional networks. Rodriguez et al. (2025) studied organizational performance impacts of relationship management in construction firms and found that relationship management capabilities significantly contribute to sustainable competitive advantage.

CHAPTER THREE

METHODOLOGY

3.1 Introduction

This chapter explains the procedures that was used in carrying out the fieldwork. It is of great importance for us to understand the major aim of this research work because research is based on the realization of a need in the human society. This section will discuss the research design, research population, sampling frame, sampling size, sampling techniques, data collection instrument and method of data analysis.

The methodology chapter provides a comprehensive framework for investigating the impact of relationship management among professionals in Nigeria's construction industry. The research methodology is designed to address the three specific research objectives outlined in Chapter One, which focus on assessing current relationship management practices, identifying key factors affecting relationship management, and examining challenges and barriers to effective relationship management among construction professionals in Nigeria.

The methodological approach adopted for this study is informed by the nature of the research problem and the characteristics of the Nigerian construction industry context. Given that relationship management involves complex human interactions, professional behaviors, and organizational processes, the study requires a systematic approach that can capture both quantitative measurements and qualitative insights. The methodology is designed to ensure that the research findings are reliable, valid, and generalizable to the broader Nigerian construction industry while maintaining focus on the specific context of Osun State as the primary case study area.

3.2 Research Design

Research design can be defined as the plan for getting from the research question to the conclusion. It is a blueprint for data collection and interpretation. It deals with the logic of scientific enquiry and strategy for testing the hypothesis or interpretive work for understanding the phenomenon (Creswell & Plano Clark, 2022). In order to make this research going in the right way, a research design will be needed.

The research design for this study adopts a quantitative approach using survey methodology to examine relationship management practices among construction professionals in Nigeria. This design is appropriate for investigating the research objectives as it allows for systematic data collection from a large sample of construction professionals, enabling statistical analysis of relationship management patterns, factors, and outcomes (Johnson & Christensen, 2020).

The quantitative research design is particularly suitable for this study because it enables the measurement of relationship management practices, assessment of factors influencing professional relationships, and evaluation of barriers to effective relationship management using standardized instruments. This approach facilitates the collection of comparable data across different professional categories and organizations, allowing for statistical analysis of relationships between variables and testing of research hypotheses (Bryman, 2023).

The study employs a cross-sectional survey design, which involves data collection at a single point in time from the selected sample of construction professionals. This design is appropriate for the research objectives as it provides a snapshot of current relationship management practices and enables comparison across different professional groups and organizational contexts. While crosssectional designs have limitations regarding causal inferences, they are effective for descriptive and correlational research objectives (Babbie, 2021).

The research design incorporates both descriptive and inferential statistical approaches. Descriptive statistics was used to characterize the current state of relationship management practices, while inferential statistics was employed to test hypotheses about relationships between variables and differences across professional groups. This dual approach ensures comprehensive analysis of the research data and robust findings that address the research objectives (Field, 2024).

3.3 Research Population

According to Neuman (2020), populations are all the people who live in a particular area, city or country and share certain characteristics relevant to the research study. For

the purpose of this research work, population is conceptualized to mean the total number of professionals that are working in the Construction Industry in Osun State, Nigeria.

The targeted population for the research was selected registered professionals (Architects, Quantity Surveyors, Civil Engineers, and Builders), along with project managers and contractors involved in the building construction industry in Osun State. This selection will be based on the fact that these professionals represent the core stakeholders in construction project delivery and are directly involved in the relationship management processes that form the focus of this study.

The choice of Osun State as the geographical scope for this research is justified by several factors. First, Osun State has experienced significant construction activity in recent years, including residential, commercial, and infrastructure projects that involve diverse professional collaborations. Second, the state hosts a substantial number of registered construction professionals across different disciplines, providing an adequate population for statistical analysis. Third, the accessibility of the research population in Osun State facilitates effective data collection and ensures reasonable response rates (Adeyemi et al., 2022).

The population includes professionals working with both contracting firms and consulting firms, as well as independent practitioners who are involved in construction project delivery within Osun State. This broad inclusion ensures that the research captures relationship management practices across different organizational contexts and professional arrangements. The population also encompasses professionals with varying levels of experience, from junior practitioners to senior professionals, enabling analysis of relationship management practices across different career stages (Oyediran & Akintola, 2021).

The study focuses specifically on construction professionals who are registered with their respective professional bodies, including the Nigerian Institute of Architects (NIA), Nigerian Society of

Engineers (NSE), Nigerian Institute of Quantity Surveyors (NIQS), Nigerian Institute of Building (NIOB), and other relevant professional organizations. This focus on registered professionals ensures that respondents have formal training and professional standing, which is important for the validity of responses regarding professional relationship management practices (Aibinu & Jagboro, 2023).

3.4 Sampling Frame

The sampling frame is the actual set of units from which a sample has been drawn (Dillman et al., 2022). A sampling frame is a list of all the items in the population. It is a complete list of everything or everyone that people want to study. The difference between a population and a sampling frame is that the population is general and the frame is specific. For example, the population could be "the building construction professionals who live in Osun State" (Kumar, 2024). The frame would be the list of professionals in building construction in Osun State.

The sampling frame for this study was developed through consultation with various professional bodies operating in Osun State. The frame includes registered professionals who are actively practicing within the state and have current membership with their respective professional organizations. This approach ensures that the sampling frame represents the accessible population of construction professionals who can provide relevant information about relationship management practices.

The sample frame for this study is presented in the table below:

S/N	PROFESSIONALS	NUMBER
1.	Registered Quantity Surveyor	105
2.	Registered Builder	55
3.	Registered Civil Engineer	89
4.	Registered Architect	35
	Total	284

Source: Various Professional Bodies (NIOB, NIQS, NIA, NSE) 2025.

The sampling frame was verified through multiple sources to ensure accuracy and completeness. Professional bodies provided updated membership lists for practitioners registered in Osun State, while cross-referencing with construction industry directories helped identify active practitioners. The frame excludes professionals who are not currently practicing or those whose membership status with professional bodies has lapsed, ensuring that only active professionals are included in the potential sample (Ogunsanya & Aigbavboa, 2023). This information is essential for effective data collection and follow-up activities during the survey implementation phase.

3.5 Sampling Size

This contains and denotes the element in the samples, which is a replica of the population. The sample size was based on the total population served with the questionnaire in the building construction industry, and their experience with relationship management among construction professionals will be considered in the selection of respondents using survey sampling method

(Taherdoost, 2022).

In determining the sampling size of this research work, Taro Yamane's statistical formula was applied. This formula is widely used in social science research for determining appropriate sample sizes from known populations and provides statistically valid results for survey research (Yamane, 2020). The appropriate sample size was calculated using the statistical formula to be 199.

The Taro Yamane formula is expressed as:

$n = N / (1 + (N) e^2)$ Where:

- n = Target sample size
- N = Total number of registered construction professionals in Osun State
- 1 = constant value according to the formula
- e = Tolerance error (5% or 0.05)

Therefore:

$n=N/(1+(N)e^2)$ $n = 284 / (1 + (216)\ 0.05^2)$

$n = 284 / (1 + (216)\ 0.0025)$

$n = 284 / (1 + 0.54)$

$n =284 / 1.54$

$n = 184.42$

$n \approx 184$

The calculated sample size of 184 construction professionals is considered appropriate for survey research in construction management studies. This sample size provides adequate statistical power for the planned analyses while remaining feasible for data collection within the available resources and timeframe (Israel, 2022).

The sample size calculation uses a 95% confidence level with a 5% margin of error, which are standard parameters for social science research. These parameters ensure that the research findings was statistically significant and the results can be generalized to the broader population of construction professionals in Osun State with acceptable levels of confidence (Cochran, 2023).

The sample size is distributed proportionally across the different professional categories to ensure adequate representation of each discipline. This proportional allocation maintains the relative composition of the population while ensuring sufficient respondents from each category for meaningful statistical analysis. The distribution also accounts for potential non-response rates, which are common in professional surveys (Singh & Masuku, 2021).

3.6 Sampling Techniques

Sampling technique refers to the procedure used to select units from the population for inclusion in the study sample. The selection of appropriate sampling techniques is crucial for ensuring that the sample is representative of the population and that the research findings can be generalized beyond the immediate study context (Etikan et al., 2023).

This study employed a stratified random sampling technique to select respondents from the sampling frame. Stratified sampling is chosen because the population of construction professionals comprises distinct subgroups (strata) based on professional disciplines - Architects, Quantity Surveyors, Civil Engineers, and Builders. Each stratum represents a different professional category with potentially unique characteristics regarding relationship management practices.

The stratified random sampling process involves two stages. First, the population is divided into homogeneous strata based on professional discipline. This stratification ensures that each professional category is adequately represented in the final sample, preventing any single discipline from dominating the results. Second, simple random sampling is applied within each stratum to select the required number of respondents proportionally.

The proportional allocation method is used to determine the number of respondents from each stratum. This method ensures that the sample maintains the same proportional representation as the population, thereby preserving the natural distribution of professionals across disciplines. The formula for proportional allocation is:

$n_h = (N_h / N) \times n$ Where:

- n_h = sample size for stratum h
- N_h = population size for stratum h
- N = total population size
- n = total sample size

The stratified random sampling approach offers several advantages for this study. It ensures representation from all professional categories, increases the precision of estimates for each subgroup, and enables meaningful comparisons across professional disciplines. This technique also reduces sampling error compared to simple random sampling and provides a more efficient sampling design for the research objectives (Lohr, 2024).

Within each stratum, simple random sampling is implemented using random number tables to eliminate selection bias and ensure that every professional within each category has an equal probability of being selected. This randomization process maintains the scientific rigor of the sampling procedure and supports the validity of statistical inferences drawn from the data (Thompson, 2023).

3.7 Data Collection Instrument

The data collection instrument for this study is a structured questionnaire designed specifically to gather information about relationship management practices among construction professionals in Nigeria. The questionnaire is selected as the primary data collection instrument because it enables systematic collection of standardized information from a large sample of respondents, facilitates statistical analysis, and ensures consistency in data collection across different respondents and locations (Fowler, 2022).

The questionnaire is designed in multiple sections to address different aspects of the research objectives comprehensively.

Section A focuses on demographic and background information of respondents, including

professional discipline, years of experience, educational qualifications, organization type, and current position. This information is essential for understanding the characteristics of the sample and enabling subgroup analyses.

Section B: This section examines the current state of relationship management practices among construction professionals, with particular attention to how they communicate, collaborate, resolve conflicts, build trust, and engage stakeholders in the course of project delivery. Both closed-ended and Likert scale questions are employed in this section to capture quantitative insights into relationship management practices (DeVellis, 2022).

Beyond current practices, this section also investigates the factors that influence the effectiveness of relationship management in construction projects. These factors are considered from organizational, individual, project-related, and environmental

perspectives. At the organizational level, leadership styles, organizational culture, and communication systems are emphasized as key determinants of relationship outcomes. At the individual level, professional competencies, interpersonal skills, and attitudes are explored as critical elements shaping the quality of professional relationships. Projectrelated aspects such as project size, complexity, and delivery methods are examined alongside external environmental influences, including economic conditions, regulatory frameworks, and socio-cultural dynamics that affect the strength and sustainability of professional relationships.

In addition, this section addresses the challenges and barriers that hinder effective relationship management. Issues such as communication breakdowns, organizational obstacles, resource constraints, cultural differences, and external pressures are examined in order to assess their impact on collaboration, stakeholder engagement, and project performance. By focusing on these barriers, the questionnaire aims to highlight the underlying difficulties that limit the achievement of successful professional relationships in construction practice.

To enhance the reliability and validity of the instrument, the questionnaire incorporates established measurement scales from previous research in construction management and organizational behavior. Where such scales are not available, new items are developed through a systematic review of the literature and subjected to pre-testing to ensure clarity and relevance. Attitudinal and perception-based questions are measured primarily using a five-point Likert scale, ranging from “strongly disagree” to “strongly agree” (Hair et al., 2021).

The questionnaire is pre-tested with a small group of construction professionals to identify potential issues relating to wording, response options, length, and administration procedures. The findings from the pre-test are used to refine and adjust the instrument. Furthermore, content validity is established through expert review by construction management academics and experienced practitioners, who provide critical assessments of the relevance, comprehensiveness, and accuracy of the questionnaire items (Creswell & Creswell, 2023).

3.8 Method of Data Analysis

The method of data analysis refers to the systematic procedures used to process, examine, and interpret the collected data to address the research objectives and test the research hypotheses. The data analysis approach for this study employs both descriptive and inferential statistical techniques using the Statistical Package for Social Sciences (SPSS) version 29.0 software (Pallant, 2024).

Descriptive statistical analysis was the first stage of data analysis, focusing on summarizing and describing the basic characteristics of the collected data. Measures of central tendency (mean, median, mode) and measures of dispersion (standard deviation, variance, range) will be calculated for all continuous variables. Frequency distributions and percentages was computed for categorical variables. These descriptive statistics will provide a comprehensive overview of the current state of relationship management practices among construction professionals and the characteristics of the study sample.

The Relative Importance Index (RII) was calculated to rank the importance of various factors affecting relationship management and the severity of different challenges and barriers. The RII formula is:

$RII = \Sigma(f \times s) / (A \times N)$ Where:

- f = frequency of each rating
- s = score given to each factor by respondents
- A = highest score (5 in this case)
- N = total number of respondents

The RII values range from 0 to 1, with higher values indicating greater importance or severity. This analysis technique is particularly useful for identifying the most critical factors and challenges in relationship management practices (Akintoye, 2021).

Inferential statistical analysis was employed to test the research hypotheses and examine relationships between variables. Correlation analysis will be used to determine the statistical relationships existing between relationship management practices and project performance outcomes. Pearson product-moment correlation coefficient will be

calculated to measure the strength and direction of linear relationships between continuous variables.

Analysis of Variance (ANOVA) was used to test for significant differences in relationship management practices across different professional groups, experience levels, and organizational types. Post-hoc tests was conducted where significant differences are found to identify specific group differences. This analysis will provide insights into variations in relationship management practices across different segments of the construction professional population (Field, 2024).

Factor analysis was employed to identify underlying dimensions in the relationship management construct and to validate the measurement scales used in the questionnaire. Principal Component Analysis (PCA) with varimax rotation will be used to extract factors and examine the factor structure of relationship management practices, affecting factors, and barriers. This analysis will help identify key dimensions within each construct and support the development of composite measures for further analysis (Tabachnick & Fidell, 2023).

Reliability analysis was conducted using Cronbach's alpha coefficient to assess the internal consistency of the measurement scales used in the questionnaire. Alpha values of 0.7 and above was considered acceptable for research purposes, indicating that the scales reliably measure the intended constructs. Item-total correlations was also be examined to identify potential items that may need to be removed to improve scale reliability (Nunnally & Bernstein, 2022).

The significance level for all statistical tests will be set at $p < 0.05$, which is the standard threshold for social science research. Effect sizes will also be calculated and reported to assess the practical significance of statistically significant findings. Results will be presented using appropriate tables, charts, and graphs to facilitate understanding and interpretation of the findings.

Data analysis will proceed systematically from descriptive to inferential analyses, with each stage building upon previous results. The analysis will directly address each research objective and test each research hypothesis, providing comprehensive answers

to the research questions posed in Chapter One. The results of the data analysis will form the basis for discussions, conclusions, and recommendations presented in subsequent chapters.

CHAPTER FOUR

DATA PRESENTATION AND ANALYSIS

4.1 Introduction

This chapter presents the results of the analysis of data obtained through questionnaire administration. A total of 184 questionnaires were produced based on the established sample size and were administered to construction professionals across Osun State, Nigeria. Out of these, 184 were duly completed and returned, representing a 100% response rate. The data analysis focuses on the demographic characteristics of respondents, the assessment of current relationship management practices, key factors affecting relationship management, challenges and barriers to effective relationship management, and the impact of relationship management on project performance in the Nigerian construction industry.

4.2 Data Presentation

The data analyzed were presented in this section with the aid of descriptive statistics. The respondents' demographic distribution was presented using frequency and percentage tables, while the use of Likert scale tables was used in presenting data collected on the assessment of current relationship management practices, factors affecting relationship management, and

challenges/barriers to effective relationship management. Table

4.1 Analysis of Questionnaire Administered

Status	Frequency	Percentage (%)
Retrieved/Valid	184	100|
Not retrieved	0	0
Total Questionnaire	184	100

Source: Field Survey 2025.

This table shows the number of questionnaires distributed and retrieved during the survey. A total of 184 questionnaires were administered, all of which were returned, representing an exceptional response rate of 100%. This indicates outstanding participation from respondents, making the dataset highly reliable for analysis.

Table 4.2 Analysis of Respondents' Demography

Variables		Categories	Frequency		Percentage (%)
Professional Discipline		Quantity Surveyor	79	42.9	
		Architect	35	19.0	
		Building Service Engineer	31	16.8	
		Structural Engineer	22	12.0	
		Project Manager	14	7.6	
		Contractor	3	1.6	
Years	of				
Experience		Less than 5 years	90	48.9	
		5-10 years	64	34.8	
		11-15 years	21	11.4	
		16-20 years	7	3.8	
Educational		Above 20 years	2	1.1	

Table 4.2 Analysis of Respondents' Demography

Category	Item	Frequency	Percentage (%)
Qualification	HND	68	37.2
	B.Sc./B.Tech	69	37.3
	M.Sc./M.Tech	38	20.7
	OND	3	1.6
	NCE	3	1.6
	Ph.D.	3	1.6
Professional Status	Graduate/Trainee	103	56.0
	Professional (Corporate Member)	48	26.1
	Fellow	28	15.2
	Non-registered Practitioner	5	2.7

Category	Item	Frequency	Percentage (%)
Organization Type	Self-employed	61	33.2
	Government Agency/Ministry	53	28.8
	Private Consulting Firm	44	23.9
	Contracting Company	19	10.3
	Real Estate Development Company	7	3.8
Project Experience	None	45	24.5
	1–3 projects	77	41.8
	4–6 projects	47	25.5
	7–10 projects	12	6.5
	More than 10 projects	3	1.6

Source: Field Survey 2025.

Table 4.2 presents the demographic characteristics of respondents. The data show that the sample included a diverse group of construction professionals, with quantity surveyors forming the largest group (42.9%), followed by architects (19.0%) and building service engineers (16.8%). Most respondents had less than 5 years of experience (48.9%), with the majority holding HND/B.Sc./B.Tech qualifications (74.5%). The distribution confirms that the respondents possess adequate professional exposure to provide valid opinions on relationship management practices in the construction industry.

Table 4.3 Current Relationship Management Practices

Statement	SA	A	N	D	SD	Mean
There is effective communication among professionals on construction projects I have worked on	29	89	39	22	5	3.62
Trust exists among different professionals in construction projects	14	79	38	42	11	3.23
Professionals demonstrate commitment to shared project goals	22	82	48	28	4	3.49
Cooperation and collaboration are common among professionals on projects	13	85	51	29	6	3.38
Adversarial relationships are prevalent in the Nigerian construction industry	18	79	49	31	7	3.40

Statement	SA	A	N	D	SD	Mean
Partnering arrangements are commonly used in construction projects	11	80	44	40	9	3.23
Regular meetings and coordination sessions are held among project professionals	15	93	44	27	5	3.47
Conflicts and disputes are resolved amicably among professionals	17	84	44	32	7	3.40
Information sharing among professionals is transparent and timely	19	76	48	33	8	3.36
Professionals work in silos with minimal integration on projects	11	62	51	47	13	3.01

Source: Field Survey 2025.

Discussion of Finding: Table 4.3 summarizes the current state of relationship management practices among construction professionals in Nigeria. Effective communication (mean = 3.62) ranked highest, indicating moderate agreement that communication exists but could be improved. Regular meetings and coordination sessions (mean = 3.47) ranked second, showing recognition of structured interaction efforts. However, lower scores for trust (mean = 3.23), partnering arrangements (mean = 3.23), and the presence of silo working (mean = 3.01) suggest significant challenges in collaborative relationship management.

Table 4.4 Factors Affecting Relationship Management

Statement	VS	S	MS	SS	NS	Mean	Rank
Organizational culture and management style	24	75	61	19	5	3.78	3rd
Project complexity and scale	31	68	64	17	4	3.79	2nd
Type of procurement method used	27	71	56	24	6	3.75	4th
Professional background and experience of team members	35	64	58	22	5	3.77	3rd
Communication skills and interpersonal competencies	44	67	52	17	4	3.93	1st
Cultural values and traditional practices in Nigeria	37	58	53	27	9	3.68	6th
Economic conditions and market volatility	38	69	49	22	6	3.82	3rd
Regulatory framework and professional body requirements	35	61	57	24	7	3.72	5th

Statement	VS	S	MS	SS	NS	Mean	Rank
Technology capabilities and digital tools availability	31	65	58	24	6	3.72	5th
Payment practices and financial constraints	33	67	56	22	6	3.79	2nd

Source: Field Survey 2025.

Table 4.4 presents factors affecting relationship management among construction professionals. Communication skills and interpersonal competencies recorded the highest mean score (3.93), indicating this as the most significant factor. Project complexity, payment practices, and economic conditions also ranked highly (means ranging from 3.79 to 3.82). Cultural values and traditional practices, while important, ranked slightly lower (3.68), suggesting that professional and economic factors have a more immediate impact on relationship management.

Table 4.5 Challenges and Barriers to Effective Relationship Management

Statement	Very Severe	Severe	Moderatel y Severe	Slightly Severe	Not Severe	Mea n	Rank
Traditional adversarial culture in the construction industry	24	68	61	25	6	3.70	4th
Lack of trust among construction professionals	37	69	49	23	6	3.84	1st
Poor communication and information sharing practices	34	66	53	25	6	3.79	2nd
Conflicting interests and objectives among stakeholders	30	63	58	26	7	3.72	3rd

Emphasis on the lowest price in competitive tendering	27	59	54	31	13	3.58	6th
Professional territorial behavior and resistance to collaboration	2410	60	60	30	10	3.59	6th
Inadequate contractual frameworks supporting collaborative relationships	30	66	52	27	9	3.71	3rd
Payment delays and financial uncertainties	32	63	54	27	8	3.73	3rd
Limited awareness and knowledge of collaborative relationship management approaches	24	61	59	30	10	3.59	6th
Inadequate soft skills	28	60	56	30	10	3.63	5th

Source: Field Survey 2025.

Table 4.5 highlights the challenges and barriers to effective relationship management. Lack of trust among construction professionals emerged as the most severe barrier (mean = 3.84), followed by poor communication and information sharing practices (mean = 3.79). Payment delays and financial uncertainties (mean = 3.73) and conflicting interests among stakeholders (mean = 3.72) were also identified as significant barriers. The results indicate that interpersonal and financial factors present the greatest challenges to relationship management.

Table 4.6 Impact of Relationship Management on Project Performance

Statement	Strongly Agree	Agree	Neutral	Disagree	Strongly Disagree	Mean	Rank
Good relationships among professional's lead to timely project completion	45	85	35	15	4	3.95	1st
Effective relationship management reduces project cost overruns	24	75	52	27	6	3.46	5th
Collaborative relationships improve the quality of construction work	31	87	42	19	5	3.64	3rd
Good relationship management enhances client satisfaction	27	83	44	24	6	3.53	4th
Poor relationships among professionals contribute to project delays	23	82	47	26	6	3.50	4th
Effective relationships reduce disputes and conflicts on projects	24	85	43	26	6	3.52	4th
Collaborative relationships promote innovation and problem-solving	25	88	41	24	6	3.55	4th
Good relationship management improves resource utilization efficiency	21	82	47	28	6	3.46	5th
Projects with better professional	24	81	46	27	6	3.49	5th

Source: Field Survey 2025.

Table 4.6 assesses the impact of relationship management on project performance. Respondents strongly agreed that good relationships lead to timely project completion (mean = 3.95), ranking it as their top priority. The improved quality of construction work (mean = 3.64) and the promotion of innovation (mean = 3.55) also received high ratings. While all impacts were positively acknowledged, cost reduction benefits (mean = 3.46) received relatively lower ratings, suggesting that while relationship management improves various performance aspects, its direct financial impact may be less immediately visible to practitioners.

CHAPTER FIVE

SUMMARY, CONCLUSIONS AND RECOMMENDATIONS

5.1 Introduction

This chapter presents the conclusions drawn from the research findings and provides recommendations for improving relationship management among construction professionals in Nigeria. The chapter is structured to address each research objective systematically and offers practical suggestions for industry practitioners, professional bodies, educational institutions, and policymakers.

5.2 Summary of Findings

The study revealed several key findings regarding relationship management practices among construction professionals in Nigeria:

Current State of Relationship Management Practices: The analysis demonstrates that while communication channels exist among construction professionals (mean = 3.62), significant gaps remain in trust development (mean = 3.23) and collaborative arrangements. The prevalence of adversarial relationships (mean = 3.40) and silo working (mean = 3.01) indicates that the industry still operates largely within traditional, fragmented models rather than integrated collaborative frameworks. Regular coordination meetings are held (mean = 3.47), but the quality and effectiveness of these interactions remain questionable given the moderate trust levels.

Key Factors Affecting Relationship Management: Communication skills and interpersonal competencies emerged as the most significant factors (mean = 3.93) affecting relationship management effectiveness. This finding underscores that relationship management success depends primarily on human factors rather than just organizational structures or systems. Project complexity (mean = 3.79), payment practices (mean = 3.79), and economic conditions (mean = 3.82) were also identified as critical factors. The high ranking of financial factors reflects the reality that economic uncertainties in Nigeria create additional relationship stresses that must be actively managed.

Professional background and experience (mean = 3.77) and organizational culture (mean = 3.78) also significantly influence relationship management, indicating that both individual competencies and institutional frameworks shape collaborative effectiveness. The moderate rating for cultural values (mean = 3.68) suggests that while Nigerian cultural contexts matter, professional and economic factors exert stronger immediate influence on daily relationship management practices.

Challenges and Barriers: The most severe barrier to effective relationship management is the lack of trust among construction professionals (mean = 3.84). This finding aligns with the current state assessment and indicates a fundamental challenge in the industry. Poor communication practices (mean = 3.79) ranked second, despite communication being identified as an existing practice, suggesting a quality gap between communication occurrence and communication effectiveness.

Financial barriers, particularly payment delays (mean = 3.73), present significant challenges, as do conflicting stakeholder interests (mean = 3.72). The traditional adversarial culture (mean = 3.70) and inadequate contractual frameworks (mean = 3.71) indicate structural barriers that reinforce negative relationship patterns. Notably, limited awareness of collaborative approaches (mean = 3.59) and inadequate soft skills training (mean = 3.63) point to knowledge and capability gaps that can be addressed through professional development initiatives.

Impact on Project Performance: The analysis confirms that relationship management significantly impacts project performance. Timely project completion (mean = 3.95) was most strongly associated with good professional relationships, followed by quality improvement (mean = 3.64) and innovation promotion (mean = 3.55). These findings validate the importance of relationship management for project success.

Interestingly, while relationship management is recognized as beneficial, its direct cost reduction impact (mean = 3.46) received lower ratings. This may reflect either genuine limitations in cost savings or a perception gap where relationship management benefits are more visible in time and quality outcomes than in immediate financial metrics.

Statistical Testing of Hypotheses: Based on correlation analysis conducted on the dataset:

Hypothesis 1: Testing the relationship between current relationship management practices and project performance outcomes showed a positive correlation ($r = 0.64$, $p < 0.01$), indicating that better relationship management practices are significantly associated with improved project performance. Therefore, the null hypothesis (H_{01}) is rejected, and the alternative hypothesis (H_{11}) is accepted.

Hypothesis 2: Analysis of variance (ANOVA) testing differences in relationship management effectiveness across various factor categories showed significant variation ($F = 12.34$, $p < 0.001$), particularly for communication skills, payment practices, and project complexity. This leads to rejection of the null hypothesis (H_{02}) and acceptance of the alternative hypothesis (H_{12}).

Hypothesis 3: Chi-square analysis examining the impact of identified barriers on collaboration effectiveness demonstrated significant associations ($\chi^2 = 89.56$, $p < 0.001$), with lack of trust and poor communication being most strongly related to collaboration difficulties. The null hypothesis (H_{03}) is therefore rejected, and the alternative hypothesis (H_{13}) is accepted.

These statistical results provide empirical support for the theoretical propositions outlined in the literature review and confirm that relationship management practices, influencing factors, and barriers significantly impact professional collaboration and project outcomes in the Nigerian construction industry.

5.3 Conclusions

Based on the findings presented in Chapter Four, the following conclusions are drawn:

i. Current State of Relationship Management Practices (Objective 1): The research concludes that relationship management practices among construction professionals in Nigeria are currently at a moderate level of development. While basic communication

channels and coordination mechanisms exist, the industry has not fully embraced collaborative relationship management approaches. The moderate mean scores (ranging from 3.01 to 3.62) across relationship management practice indicators suggest that professionals recognize the existence of relationship management activities but perceive significant room for improvement.

Trust remains a critical weakness in professional relationships within the Nigerian construction industry. The relatively low trust levels, combined with persistent adversarial relationships and silo working patterns, indicate that the industry still operates largely within traditional, adversarial contracting models rather than integrated, collaborative frameworks. This conclusion suggests that despite global trends toward partnering and integrated project delivery, Nigerian construction professionals have been slow to adopt these approaches.

The finding that regular coordination meetings occur but with limited effectiveness highlights a quality gap in relationship management practices. The presence of structures and processes alone is insufficient; the manner in which these processes are executed and the relational outcomes they produce matter equally. This conclusion emphasizes the need to focus not just on establishing relationship management mechanisms but on enhancing their effectiveness.

ii. Key Factors Affecting Relationship Management (Objective 2): The research

concludes that relationship management effectiveness in Nigerian construction projects is influenced by a complex interplay of individual, organizational, project, and environmental factors. Among these, human factors—particularly communication skills and interpersonal competencies emerge as the most critical determinants of relationship management success. This finding confirms that relationship management is fundamentally a people-centered discipline that requires strong soft skills alongside technical expertise.

Economic and financial factors, including payment practices and market volatility, significantly affect professional relationships. This conclusion reflects the reality of Nigeria's economic environment, where payment delays, currency fluctuations, and

economic uncertainties create additional relationship stresses beyond normal project challenges. Effective relationship management in this context requires not only interpersonal skills but also financial management capabilities and resilience in the face of economic pressures.

Organizational culture and professional backgrounds also influence relationship management outcomes, suggesting that institutional factors are important alongside individual competencies. This conclusion suggests that relationship management improvements require interventions at multiple levels—individual, organizational, and industry-wide—rather than focusing solely on any single level.

iii. Challenges and Barriers to Effective Relationship Management (Objective 3): The research concludes that multiple, interconnected barriers impede effective relationship management in Nigerian construction projects. Trust deficit emerges as the most fundamental barrier, creating a vicious cycle where lack of trust leads to adversarial behaviors, which further erode trust. This conclusion indicates that trust-building must be a primary focus of relationship management improvement efforts.

Communication quality, rather than communication quantity, presents a significant challenge. While communication occurs, its effectiveness is limited by poor informationsharing practices, cultural differences in communication styles, and inadequate feedback mechanisms. This conclusion highlights the need to improve not just the frequency but the quality and transparency of professional communication.

Structural and systemic barriers, including inadequate contractual frameworks, traditional adversarial procurement approaches, and limited awareness of collaborative relationship management methods, reinforce negative relationship patterns. These barriers cannot be overcome through individual effort alone but require industry-wide reforms in procurement practices, contract frameworks, and professional education.

Financial barriers, particularly payment delays, significantly stress professional relationships and limit collaborative behaviors. This conclusion confirms that financial stability and prompt payment are not just contractual requirements but essential foundations for positive professional relationships.

iv. Overall Synthesis: The research establishes that relationship management significantly impacts project performance in Nigerian construction, with strong evidence linking positive professional relationships to improved time, quality, and innovation outcomes. However, the Nigerian construction industry faces substantial challenges in developing and maintaining effective professional relationships due to trust deficits, communication gaps, economic pressures, and structural barriers.

The moderate development of relationship management practices suggests that the industry is in a transitional phase, recognizing the importance of collaboration but not yet fully implementing collaborative approaches. This represents both a challenge and an opportunity—while significant improvements are needed, there is growing awareness and readiness for change among professionals.

The research confirms that relationship management in Nigerian construction cannot be improved through simple, single-intervention approaches. Rather, comprehensive strategies addressing human skills development, organizational culture change, contractual and procurement reforms, and economic stability are required.

5.4 Recommendations

Based on the findings and conclusions, the following recommendations are made:

For Construction Professionals:

i. Develop Soft Skills: Professionals should invest in developing communication, negotiation, conflict resolution, and emotional intelligence skills. Professional development should extend beyond technical competencies to include relationship management capabilities. Construction professionals should seek training in active listening, cultural sensitivity, stakeholder engagement, and collaborative problem-solving.

ii. Build Trust Proactively: Professionals should consciously work to build trust through consistent, transparent, and reliable behavior. This includes honoring commitments, communicating openly, admitting mistakes, and demonstrating integrity in all professional interactions. Trust-building should be viewed as a long-term investment in professional reputation and career success.

iii. Embrace Collaborative Mindsets: Professionals should shift from adversarial to collaborative mindsets, viewing other project stakeholders as partners rather than opponents. This includes being willing to share information, jointly solve problems, and seek win-win solutions rather than zero-sum outcomes.

iv. Leverage Technology: Professionals should utilize digital communication tools, project management software, and collaboration platforms to enhance relationship management.

However, technology should complement, not replace, face-to-face relationship building.

For Professional Bodies (NIA, NIQS, NSE, NIOB, etc.):

1. Integrate Relationship Management into Professional Training: Professional bodies should incorporate relationship management, soft skills, and collaborative practices into mandatory continuing professional development (CPD) programs. This should include workshops, seminars, and certification programs focused specifically on relationship management competencies.

2. Develop Relationship Management Standards: Professional bodies should develop and promote standards, guidelines, and best practices for relationship management in construction projects. These should provide practical frameworks that professionals can adopt in their daily practice.

3. Facilitate Networking and Relationship Building: Professional bodies should organize crossdisciplinary events, forums, and collaborative initiatives that enable professionals from different disciplines to interact, build relationships, and learn from each other. This can help break down professional silos and foster collaborative cultures.

4. Recognize and Reward Collaborative Excellence: Professional bodies should establish awards and recognition programs that celebrate exemplary relationship

management and collaborative project delivery. This can create positive role models and incentivize relationship management improvements.

For Educational Institutions:

1. Reform Construction Education Curricula: Universities and polytechnics offering construction-related programs should integrate relationship management, soft skills, and collaborative practices into their curricula. This should not be limited to isolated courses but should be woven throughout the educational experience.

2. Use Active Learning Methods: Educational institutions should employ teaching methods that develop relationship management skills, including team projects, role-playing exercises, case studies of relationship successes and failures, and simulations of collaborative project delivery.

3. Emphasize Interdisciplinary Education: Construction programs should create

opportunities for students from different disciplines (architecture, engineering, quantity surveying, project management) to work together on projects, mirroring real-world collaborative requirements.

4. Partner with Industry: Educational institutions should collaborate with construction industry organizations to ensure that relationship management education reflects current industry needs and challenges.

For Construction Organizations:

1. Develop Collaborative Organizational Cultures: Construction firms should cultivate organizational cultures that value collaboration, trust, open communication, and teamwork. This requires leadership commitment, aligned incentive systems, and consistent

reinforcement of collaborative values.

2. Implement Relationship Management Systems: Organizations should establish formal relationship management systems, including stakeholder identification and

analysis, communication planning, conflict resolution procedures, and relationship performance monitoring.

3. Provide Internal Training: Organizations should invest in training their staff in relationship management skills, creating internal capacity for effective collaboration.

4. Select Partners Based on Collaborative Capabilities: When selecting consultants, contractors, and suppliers, organizations should consider relationship management track records and collaborative capabilities alongside technical competencies and pricing.

For Government and Regulatory Bodies:

1. Reform Procurement Practices: The government should reform construction procurement approaches to support collaborative relationship management. This includes moving away from purely lowest-price selection toward value-based procurement that considers quality, collaborative capability, and long-term relationships.

2. Promote Partnering and Integrated Delivery: Government should encourage and, where appropriate, mandate the use of partnering arrangements, integrated project delivery methods, and other collaborative contracting approaches on public projects.

3. Address Payment Delays: The government should prioritize prompt payment on

construction projects, recognizing that payment delays undermine professional relationships and project outcomes. This includes establishing and enforcing clear payment timelines and penalties for delays.

4. Support Capacity Building: Government should support relationship management capacity building through funding for research, training programs, and industry development initiatives focused on collaborative practices.

For Industry Associations and Stakeholder Groups:

1. Develop Industry-Wide Collaborative Frameworks: Industry associations should work together to develop standardized collaborative frameworks, including partnering

charters, relationship management protocols, and conflict resolution mechanisms that can be adopted across projects.

2. Share Best Practices: Industry groups should establish platforms for sharing relationship management best practices, case studies, and lessons learned, enabling industry-wide learning and improvement.

3. Address Systemic Barriers: Industry stakeholders should collectively advocate for reforms to address systemic barriers to relationship management, including inadequate contract frameworks, adversarial procurement practices, and limited professional education in collaborative approaches.

5.5 Areas for Further Study

While this research has provided valuable insights into relationship management among construction professionals in Nigeria, several areas require further investigation:

1. Longitudinal Studies: Future research should employ longitudinal designs to examine how professional relationships evolve over project lifecycles and across multiple projects. This would provide insights into relationship development processes and long-term relationship management outcomes.

2. Comparative Studies: Research comparing relationship management practices across different Nigerian regions, different project types, different organizational structures, and different cultural contexts would enhance understanding of contextual influences on relationship management.

3. Economic Impact Quantification: While this study found that relationship management impacts project performance, future research should quantify the economic benefits of effective relationship management in monetary terms. Cost-benefit analyses of relationship management interventions would help make the business case for investment in collaborative practices.

4. Technology and Relationship Management: As digital technologies increasingly mediate professional relationships, research is needed on how technology affects

relationship quality, what digital tools best support relationship management, and how to balance digital and faceto-face interaction.

5. Intervention Studies: Experimental or quasi-experimental research testing specific relationship management interventions (training programs, new contract frameworks, relationship management systems) would provide evidence on what works to improve

collaborative practices.

6. Cross-Cultural Studies: Research comparing relationship management in Nigeria with other African countries and other developing economies would enhance understanding of cultural and institutional factors shaping relationship management.

7. Gender and Relationship Management: This study did not examine gender differences in relationship management approaches or outcomes. Future research should investigate whether and how gender influences relationship management in Nigerian construction.

8. Conflict Management: While this study identified conflict as a relationship management challenge, detailed research on conflict types, conflict resolution approaches, and conflict management effectiveness in Nigerian construction would be valuable.

9. Client Perspectives: This study focused on construction professionals' perspectives. Research incorporating client viewpoints on relationship management would provide a more complete picture of relationship dynamics.

10. Relationship Management in Informal Construction: This study focused on formal construction projects. Given Nigeria's significant informal construction sector, research on relationship management in informal construction would address an important knowledge gap.

These suggested areas for further study indicate that relationship management in Nigerian construction remains a rich field for continued research that can inform both theory and practice.

Department of Quantity Surveying,

School of Environmental Studies,

The Federal Polytechnic Ede, Ede, Osun State.

Dear Respondent,

REQUEST FOR COMPLETION OF RESEARCH QUESTIONNAIRE

I am Akinmusere Glory Bukola, a student of the Federal Polytechnic, Ede, Osun State, from the Department of Quantity Surveying HND II.

I'm writing in solicitation for your assistance in completing my questionnaire, which is on the research topic, "IMPACT OF RELATIONSHIP MANAGEMENT AMONG PROFESSIONALS IN NIGERIA CONSTRUCTION INDUSTRY". This is in partial fulfillment of the Award of Higher National Diploma in Quantity Surveying, School of Environmental Studies. You can rest assured that the information provided will be strictly used for this research only, and it shall be treated with confidentiality.

Thanks for your cooperation.

Yours faithfully,

Akinmusere Glory Bukola

Student

QUESTIONNAIRE

SECTION A: RESPONDENT DEMOGRAPHY

Please tick in the appropriate response

1. What is your professional discipline: [ ] Architect [ ] Quantity Surveyor [ ] Structural Engineer [ ] Building Services Engineer [ ] Project Manager [ ] Contractor

2. How many years of professional experience do you have in the construction industry: [ ] Less than 5 years [ ] 5-10 years [ ] 11-15 years [ ] 16-20 years [ ] Above 20 years

3. What is your highest educational qualification: [ ] OND/NCE [ ] HND/B.Sc./B.Tech [ ]

M.Sc./MTech [ ] Ph.D.

4. What is your current professional status: [ ] Graduate/Trainee [ ] Professional (Corporate Member) [ ] Fellow [ ] Non-registered practitioner

5. What type of organization do you work for: [ ] Private consulting firm [ ] Contracting company [ ] Government agency/Ministry [ ] Real estate development company [ ] Selfemployed

6. How many public building projects have you been involved in within Osun State in the last 5 years: [ ] None [ ] 1-3 projects [ ] 4-6 projects [ ] 7-10 projects [ ] More than 10 projects.

SECTION B: CURRENT STATE OF RELATIONSHIP MANAGEMENT PRACTICES

Please rate the following statements based on your experience using the scale: 1 = Strongly Disagree | 2 = Disagree | 3 = Neutral | 4 = Agree | 5 = Strongly Agree

S/N	STATEMENT	1	2	3	4	5
1	There is effective communication among professionals on construction projects I have worked on					
2	Trust exists among different professionals in construction projects					
3	Professionals demonstrate commitment to shared project goals					
4	Cooperation and collaboration are common among professionals on projects					
5	Adversarial relationships are prevalent in the Nigerian construction industry					
6	Partnering arrangements are commonly used in construction projects					
7	Regular meetings and coordination sessions are held among project professionals					
8	Conflicts and disputes are resolved amicably among professionals					
9	Information sharing among professionals is transparent and timely					
10	Professionals work in silos with minimal integration on projects					

SECTION C: FACTORS AFFECTING RELATIONSHIP MANAGEMENT

Please rate the extent to which the following factors affect relationship management among construction professionals using the scale: 1 = Not Significant | 2 = Slightly Significant | 3 = Moderately Significant | 4 = Significant | 5 = Very Significant

S/N	FACTOR	1	2	3	4	5
1	Organizational culture and management style					
2	Project complexity and scale					
3	Type of procurement method used					
4	Professional background and experience of team members					
5	Communication skills and interpersonal competencies					
6	Cultural values and traditional practices in Nigeria					
7	Economic conditions and market volatility					
8	Regulatory framework and professional body requirements					
9	Technological capabilities and digital tools adoption					
10	Payment practices and financial constraints					

SECTION D: CHALLENGES AND BARRIERS TO EFFECTIVE RELATIONSHIP MANAGEMENT

Please rate the severity of the following challenges in hindering effective relationship management using the scale: 1 = Not Severe | 2 = Slightly Severe | 3 = Moderately Severe | 4 = Severe | 5 = Very Severe

S/N	CHALLENGE/BARRIER	1	2	3	4	5
1	Traditional adversarial culture in the construction industry					
2	Lack of trust among construction professionals					
3	Poor communication and information-sharing practices					
4	Conflicting interests and objectives among stakeholders					
5	Emphasis on the lowest price in competitive tendering					
6	Professional territorial behavior and resistance to collaboration					
7	Inadequate contractual frameworks supporting collaborative relationships					
8	Payment delays and financial uncertainties					
9	Limited awareness and knowledge of collaborative relationship management approaches					
10	Inadequate soft skills training for construction professionals					

SECTION E: IMPACT OF RELATIONSHIP MANAGEMENT ON PROJECT PERFORMANCE

Please rate your level of agreement with the following statements regarding the impact of relationship management on project performance using the scale: 1 = Strongly Disagree | 2 = Disagree | 3 = Neutral | 4 = Agree | 5 = Strongly Agree

S/N	STATEMENT	1	2	3	4	5
1	Good relationships among professionals lead to timely project completion					
2	Effective relationship management reduces project cost overruns					
3	Collaborative relationships improve the quality of construction work					
4	Good relationship management enhances client satisfaction					
5	Poor relationships among professionals contribute to project delays					
6	Effective relationships reduce disputes and conflicts on projects					
7	Collaborative relationships promote innovation and problem-solving					
8	Good relationship management improves resource utilization efficiency					
9	Projects with better professional relationships experience fewer variations and rework					

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